

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Central question and the root access condition

CENTRAL QUESTION -> how does a state with no land access build Eurasian presence?

ROOT CONDITION -> Pakistan and Afghanistan lie between India and the five Republics

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AXIS 1 -> POLICY: Connect Central Asia Policy, 2012, broad-based

AXIS 2 -> FORUMS: SCO seat | India-Central Asia Summit and Dialogue

AXIS 3 -> CORRIDORS: INSTC | Chabahar | Ashgabat Agreement

RULE -> the constraint is the spine of the answer, not an afterthought

MUST REMEMBER: Central Asia and Eurasia policy connects continental access, energy,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: The two overland routes and why both fail

ROUTE A -> via Afghanistan and Pakistan

FAILS ON: transit unavailability and Afghan instability

ROUTE B -> via Xinjiang, then across the Karakoram and Himalayan ranges

FAILS ON: extreme geography plus required Chinese cooperation

SOURCE -> Sikri on any Eurasia-to-India pipeline avoiding Afghanistan or Pakistan

VERDICT -> a structural constraint, not an engineering problem awaiting a solution

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Policy classification: what broad-based actually means

CONNECT CENTRAL ASIA POLICY, LAUNCHED 2012

- |-- POLITICAL -> sustained high-level engagement with the five Republics
- |-- SECURITY -> counter-terrorism and security-council-level consultation
- |-- ECONOMIC -> market integration proposal with the Eurasian space
- +-- CULTURAL -> people-to-people and cultural connections

FIVE REPUBLICS -> Kazakhstan | Kyrgyzstan | Tajikistan | Turkmenistan | Uzbekistan

TRAP -> reducing a broad-based policy to an energy policy misstates its scope

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Economic-integration instrument: proposal to open negotiation

PROPOSED -> Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreement with the Eurasian space

-> 3 JUNE 2017, ST PETERSBURG: India-EAEU free-trade negotiation formally begins

-> 22-25 JUNE 2026, MOSCOW: second round held

STATUS -> under negotiation; neither signed nor in force

ALSO CITED -> Eurasian Economic Community and the Custom Union as existing fora

RULE -> cite the dated rounds as engagement, never as an achieved agreement

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: SCO participation matrix as of 3 August 2026

FULL MEMBERS (10) | Belarus | China | India | Iran | Kazakhstan
| Kyrgyzstan | Pakistan | Russia | Tajikistan | Uzbekistan
OBSERVERS (2) | Afghanistan | Mongolia
DIALOGUE PARTNERS | 15
ACCESSIONS -> Pakistan 2017 | Iran 2023 | Belarus 2024
1 SEPTEMBER 2025 -> decision envisaging a single SCO Partner status
PENDING -> the enabling amendments had not entered into force
TRAP -> Sikri's observer list is period-specific and must be dated when quoted

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Dedicated regional format and its honest gap

27 JANUARY 2022 -> first India-Central Asia Summit, held virtually

6 JUNE 2025 -> fourth India-Central Asia Dialogue, New Delhi, foreign-minister level;
envisaged preparing the ground for a second summit

16 OCTOBER 2025 -> third meeting of Security Council Secretaries and NSAs, Bishkek

31 AUGUST-1 SEPTEMBER 2025 -> SCO summit at Tianjin adopts the Tianjin Declaration;
Kyrgyzstan chairs 2025-26 with the next summit scheduled for Bishkek

GAP -> no second leader-level summit recorded as held by 3 August 2026

CLOSE DISTINCTION: INSTC, Chabahar, Ashgabat Agreement, SCO and bilateral connectivity...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Chabahar instrument priced component by component

13 MAY 2024 -> ten-year long-term contract, India Ports Global Limited with
Iran's Ports and Maritime Organisation

USD 120 MILLION -> announced equipment investment; LEVEL: announcement

USD 250 MILLION -> announced credit window for mutually identified infrastructure

LEVEL -> announced credit window, not disbursed finance

RULE -> announcement and delivery are different evidentiary levels

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Sanctions exposure path and its consequence

16 SEPTEMBER 2025 -> United States State Department revokes the 2018 waiver

-> 29 SEPTEMBER 2025: revocation takes effect

-> ASSURANCE: non-exposure runs only to 26 April 2026

-> BEYOND THAT DATE: status requires fresh verification

LEGAL CHARACTER -> another state's domestic sanctions posture; exposure for entities

NOT -> an international legal obligation binding on India

CONSEQUENCE -> the Iran work-around becomes a financing question, not a map question

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Corridor status ladder

ANNOUNCED FRAMEWORK -> International North-South Transport Corridor

|-- intended to reach Central Asia and Eurasia bypassing Pakistan

|-- OPERATING SEGMENTS exist

+-- NOT a completed, full-capacity corridor

25 APRIL 2011 -> Ashgabat Agreement signed; India joined from 3 FEBRUARY 2018

|-- multimodal transport and transit corridor to the Persian Gulf and Gulf of Oman

+-- LIMIT: a facilitation framework, not an infrastructure-finance mechanism

RULE -> capacity and completion claims need independent dated verification

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Competitive field and the limits of Indian agency

PROBLEM -> the region abuts major Asian powers and will always attract foreign presences

RESPONSE: sustained diplomacy through a seat, a dialogue and corridor instruments

PROBLEM -> Russian and Chinese proximity is greater than India's

RESPONSE: accept co-determined outcomes rather than claiming regional primacy

PROBLEM -> mixed SCO membership includes Pakistan

RESPONSE: the forum sustains engagement; it cannot resolve transit access

VERDICT -> multi-actor competition, expressly not Indian determinism

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Functional cooperation inside strategic mistrust

COMPETITION -> India and China seek energy from the same sources

EFFECT -> that competition only benefits the energy producers

SIKRI'S RECOMMENDATION -> develop an understanding on energy with China

COEXISTENCE -> cooperation on one function alongside unresolved strategic mistrust

BOUNDARY -> the wider India-China strategic relationship belongs to topic 03

USE -> avoids the crude choice between pure rivalry and naive partnership

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Answer spine for a Central Asia demand

OPEN -> state the absence of direct land access before listing any opportunity

BUILD -> policy, forums and corridors, each with one dated instrument at its level

TEST -> price sanctions exposure, the unheld summit and the open negotiation honestly

CLOSE -> convert goodwill into reliable access as the graded verdict, predicting nothing

EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Map India-Iran-Russia-Central Asia...